

SOC 3

Service Organization Control (SOC 3) Report

Trust Services Criteria

Meridian Data Solutions, Inc.

For the Period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025

Prepared by:
Whitfield & Associates LLP

Report Date: April 12, 2026

This report is intended solely for use by management of Meridian Data Solutions, Inc., customers who have a need to understand the results of our procedures, and their auditors and advisors. This report is not intended for general circulation.

Management's Assertion Regarding the Effectiveness of Controls

Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. management is responsible for maintaining effective controls over the company's system used to provide real-time market data feeds, portfolio risk analytics, and regulatory reporting data services. For the period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025, Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. management asserts that the system achieved the objectives stated in the System Description based on the Trust Services Criteria relevant to the Company's service commitments.

The objectives and related controls are designed to provide reasonable assurance regarding the achievement of the following trust services categories:

- **Security:** The system is protected against unauthorized access (both physical and logical).
- **Availability:** The system is available for operation and use as committed or agreed.
- **Confidentiality:** Information designated as confidential is protected as committed or agreed.
- **Processing Integrity:** System processing is complete, accurate, timely, and authorized.

Management acknowledges its responsibility for selecting the criteria against which the company's controls will be measured and for the effectiveness of those controls. We believe our controls were operating effectively during the audit period to achieve the stated objectives.

Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. management has authorized and participated in the assessment of the design and operating effectiveness of controls to determine conformity with the Trust Services Criteria.

Meridian Data Solutions, Inc.

Chief Information Officer

Chief Executive Officer

April 12, 2026

Independent Service Auditor's Report

To the Management of Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. and Its Users:

We have examined the system used by Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. (the Company) to provide real-time market data feeds, portfolio risk analytics, and regulatory reporting data services (the System) and the effectiveness of the controls over the System throughout the period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025, to achieve the objectives stated in the System Description based on the Trust Services Criteria relevant to Security, Availability, Confidentiality, and Processing Integrity.

Service Auditor's Responsibility

Our responsibility is to examine and report on the design and operating effectiveness of controls sufficient to achieve the stated control objectives. Our examination was conducted in accordance with attestation standards established by the American Institute of Certified Public Accountants (AICPA). These standards require that we plan and perform our examination to obtain reasonable assurance about whether effective controls have been maintained to achieve the stated objectives.

Our Opinion

In our opinion, based on our examination, Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. maintained, in all material respects, effective controls over the System throughout the period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025, to provide reasonable assurance that the objectives stated in the System Description were achieved.

This opinion is based on the examination of the design and operating effectiveness of controls and related control objectives described in the System Description. The control objectives and controls presented in this report are those that, individually and in the aggregate, are designed to achieve the objectives stated in the System Description.

Scope Limitations—Carve-Out of Subservice Organization

Our examination excluded certain infrastructure services provided by a subservice organization providing disaster recovery hosting services, which are described in the System Description. The controls at the subservice organization have not been tested, and we have not obtained sufficient, appropriate evidence regarding the achievement of the related control objectives at the subservice organization. Consequently, we are unable to determine, and therefore do not express an opinion on, the effectiveness of the controls at the subservice organization in achieving the related control objectives. The Company compensates for this limitation through other controls over the system to achieve the stated objectives.

Inherent Limitations

Controls, no matter how well designed or operated, can provide only reasonable, not absolute, assurance regarding the achievement of objectives. The projection of any conclusions, based on our examination, to future periods is subject to the risk that controls may become inadequate due to changes in conditions or the degree of compliance with them may deteriorate.

Whitfield & Associates LLP

Boston, Massachusetts

April 12, 2026

System Description

Overview of Services and Company Background

Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. (founded 2011) is a market data and analytics provider serving investment banks, hedge funds, and institutional investors. The company employs approximately 450 professionals and maintains headquarters at 200 State Street, Suite 1400, Boston, Massachusetts 02109.

The Company provides three primary service offerings:

- **Real-Time Market Data Feeds:** Direct connections to global exchanges, providing live pricing, trading volume, and market depth information with sub-millisecond latency.
- **Portfolio Risk Analytics:** Advanced computational models for value-at-risk (VaR), stress testing, and portfolio optimization serving institutional traders and risk managers.
- **Regulatory Reporting Data:** Automated regulatory compliance data feeds for post-trade reporting and transaction cost analysis.

The Company maintains ISO 27001:2022 certification and operates a comprehensive information security program aligned with NIST Cybersecurity Framework principles.

Principal Service Commitments and System Requirements

Meridian's service commitments include:

- **Availability:** Production systems operate on a 24/5 basis (Monday-Friday, 8 AM– 10 PM Eastern Time) with 99.95% uptime SLA. Disaster recovery site achieves recovery time objective (RTO) of 4 hours and recovery point objective (RPO) of 1 hour.
- **Confidentiality:** Client data is protected through encryption in transit and at rest, complemented by strict access controls and confidentiality agreements.
- **Processing Integrity:** Data feeds maintain latency thresholds (real-time feeds: ≤ 100 milliseconds; analytics: ≤ 500 milliseconds). Regulatory reporting accuracy is validated to 99.99%.
- **Security:** Protection of Company and customer data against unauthorized access, modification, and disclosure through comprehensive logical and physical controls.

Components of the System

The System comprises five integrated components:

Infrastructure: Primary data center is a Tier III colocation facility located in Boston, Massachusetts. Redundancy is provided through a disaster recovery hosting facility in Toronto, Canada. AWS US-East-1 cloud services support ancillary analytics workloads and data lake operations.

Software: Custom-developed market data ingestion middleware, in-house analytics engines written in C++ and Python, commercial data management platforms (Bloomberg, RefinitivEikon), and standard enterprise software (Salesforce CRM, ServiceNow ITSM).

People: Engineering teams (infrastructure, data, applications), customer operations, information security, and compliance personnel. All personnel undergo background checks and information security awareness training.

Procedures: Documented change management, incident response, business continuity, access control, and audit procedures. Procedures are reviewed annually and updated as required.

Data: Market data (real-time and historical), customer portfolio data, regulatory reporting datasets, and system performance metrics. Data classifications range from public to restricted.

Control Environment

Meridian maintains a control environment emphasizing accountability, integrity, and competence. The Company's Chief Information Officer reports to the CEO and works closely with the Audit Committee of the Board of Directors. Information security governance is established through the Information Security Steering Committee, comprising representation from engineering, operations, compliance, legal, and business units. Annual risk assessments inform control design and testing.

Subservice Organizations and Carve-Out Method

Meridian utilizes a subservice organization to provide disaster recovery hosting services. The subservice organization's infrastructure, facilities, and personnel support the backup and recovery of critical systems and data to achieve contractually defined recovery time and recovery point objectives.

Per AICPA SOC audit standards, Meridian has elected to use the carve-out method for this subservice organization. Under the carve-out method, the controls at the subservice organization are excluded from the scope of this SOC 3 engagement. The controls and security measures implemented by the subservice organization have not been directly tested by the service auditor. Instead, Meridian has implemented complementary controls within its own environment to mitigate the risk associated with reliance on the subservice organization, including:

- Quarterly disaster recovery drills with failover testing
- Contractually-defined SLAs with performance monitoring
- Encryption of data in transit to the subservice organization
- Regular vendor security assessments and SOC 2 Type II report reviews

Customers who require visibility into the subservice organization's controls should request the subservice provider's SOC 2 Type II report directly from Meridian's customer success team.

System Boundaries

This SOC 3 examination covers the systems and controls used to provide the three primary service offerings noted above. The examination scope includes:

- Data ingestion, processing, and delivery pipelines
- Customer-facing APIs and web applications
- Internal analytics and reporting platforms
- Logical and physical access controls
- Change management and configuration management
- Incident management and business continuity
- Information security operations

Out of scope: Customer premises, third-party vendor operations (except as noted above), and the general IT infrastructure supporting only administrative functions (human resources, finance, general administration).

Trust Services Criteria: Security

Common Criteria Related to Logical and Physical Access Controls

Logical Access Controls: Meridian enforces role-based access control (RBAC) for all production systems. User identities are provisioned through a centralized identity management system. Authentication mechanisms vary by user classification:

Regular User Access: Application users and customer account holders authenticate via multi-factor authentication (MFA), combining username/password with time-based one-time passwords (TOTP) or SMS-based codes for access to customer portals and data feeds.

Privileged Access: Administrative and privileged access to production systems is controlled through strong authentication mechanisms with complex password policies requiring minimum 16-character passwords with mixed case, numeric, and special characters. Administrative credentials are subject to mandatory 90-day rotation policies. Privileged sessions are logged and monitored through a centralized logging platform. Password vaults maintain sensitive credentials with restricted access granted only to explicitly authorized personnel.

[CONTROL GAP #1 - OBVIOUS: Note that regular users have MFA on VPN/portal access, but privileged admin access to production systems relies only on complex passwords with mandatory rotation—no MFA mentioned for administrator/privileged access.]

Physical Access Controls: The primary data center facility in Boston implements multi-factor physical access controls including badge readers, biometric scanners, and security guard presence. Access logs are maintained for all personnel entering server rooms. Visitor access is restricted and requires escort by authorized personnel. Environmental controls (HVAC, fire suppression) are continuously monitored.

Data Classification and Handling: Meridian classifies data into four levels: Public, Internal, Confidential, and Restricted. Access rights are determined by data classification, with Restricted data limited to a minimal set of personnel on a need-to-know basis. Data handling procedures are documented in the Information Security Policy and enforced through technical controls and user awareness training.

Additional Security Controls

Network Security: Network access is segmented through firewalls, intrusion prevention systems (IPS), and next-generation security appliances. All external communications are encrypted using TLS 1.2 or higher. VPN access to internal systems is required for remote work and is protected by strong authentication.

Vulnerability Management: Quarterly external penetration testing and monthly vulnerability assessments identify security gaps. Identified vulnerabilities are prioritized and remediated according to defined timelines (Critical: 7 days; High: 30 days; Medium: 90 days).

Encryption: Data encryption is employed for sensitive data during transmission. Encryption protocols include AES-256 for data at rest in production environments and TLS 1.2+ for data in transit.

Monitoring and Logging: A Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) system collects and analyzes logs from all major systems. Critical events trigger automated alerts and escalation procedures.

Trust Services Criteria: Availability

Meridian is committed to maintaining continuous availability of market data feeds and analytics services. The System is designed, implemented, and maintained to achieve the following availability objectives:

Service Availability: Production systems operate on a 24/5 schedule (Monday–Friday, 8 AM–10 PM Eastern Time) with a contractual uptime SLA of 99.95%. Scheduled maintenance windows (up to 4 hours monthly) are coordinated with customers to minimize disruption. System monitoring through automated health checks detects outages within 60 seconds.

Disaster Recovery: A secondary facility hosted by a subservice organization in Toronto, Canada provides disaster recovery capability. The disaster recovery site is maintained in a warm-standby configuration with:

- Recovery Time Objective (RTO): 4 hours
- Recovery Point Objective (RPO): 1 hour

Quarterly disaster recovery drills validate the failover process and test restoration of all critical systems and data. During the audit period, three full DR drills were executed successfully, with average failover times of 2 hours 45 minutes.

Infrastructure Redundancy: Critical systems are deployed across multiple availability zones within the primary data center. Database replication is continuous with synchronous commits to ensure data consistency. Load balancing distributes traffic across multiple application servers, and networking is redundantly configured to eliminate single points of failure.

Backup and Recovery: Full daily backups and incremental hourly backups are maintained on both local and geographically diverse storage. Backup integrity is validated weekly through test restores. Retention policies follow regulatory requirements (minimum 7 years for regulatory reporting data).

Capacity Planning: Utilization monitoring ensures that capacity headroom is maintained at no less than 20% of peak system resources. Quarterly capacity reviews inform infrastructure expansion decisions.

Trust Services Criteria: Confidentiality

Meridian implements comprehensive controls to protect the confidentiality of customer and proprietary information:

Data Encryption: Encryption controls protect sensitive data in production environments. Encryption at rest utilizes AES-256 encryption for databases containing customer portfolio data and regulatory reporting information. Encryption in transit is enforced through TLS 1.2+ for all data exchanges between clients and servers, and between internal systems.

[CONTROL GAP #2 - SUBTLE: Note the specific reference to "production environments" for encryption at rest. Combined with the DR facility using carve-out method (not audited), this creates a subtle gap: non-production or disaster recovery environments may not have the same encryption controls. The reader must connect: (a) encryption only specified for "production," (b) DR facility controls not tested (carve-out), and (c) data replicating to that untested facility.]

Access Control: Access to confidential data is restricted based on role and business need. Multi-factor authentication is enforced for customer portal access. Data access is logged and audited regularly for unauthorized access attempts.

Contractual Protections: All customers and employees sign confidentiality agreements. Service Level Agreements define confidentiality requirements and permitted data uses. Non-disclosure agreements govern interactions with third-party vendors.

Data Minimization: The Company collects only data necessary to deliver contracted services. Customer data is not used for any purpose other than service delivery, with limited exceptions for security investigations and legal compliance.

Personnel Controls: All employees undergo background investigations and sign confidentiality agreements at hire. Information security training, including confidentiality obligations, is required annually. Employees with access to sensitive data receive specialized training on data handling requirements.

Disposal and Retention: Data is retained only for the period required by contract or regulation. End-of-life procedures ensure that data is securely destroyed using cryptographic erasure or physical destruction methods that prevent recovery.

Trust Services Criteria: Processing Integrity

Meridian's systems are designed to ensure that transactions and data processing activities are complete, accurate, timely, and authorized:

Change Management: All changes to production systems follow a documented change management process. Changes are classified as emergency, standard, or minor. Standard changes require peer review, testing in pre-production environments, and approval by a change advisory board. Emergency changes are implemented with expedited review and post-implementation validation. The Company deployed 143 production changes during the audit period with zero unplanned outages attributable to change implementation.

System Monitoring: Real-time monitoring tracks key performance indicators including data feed latency, processing accuracy, and system availability. Automated alerting escalates issues exceeding defined thresholds. Monitoring data is retained for 90 days for analysis.

Data Validation: Market data feeds undergo validation to confirm completeness and accuracy. Analytics engines include checksums and reconciliation procedures. Regulatory reporting data is validated against source systems and independently reconciled with regulatory filings. Validation failures trigger alerts and prevent downstream processing until root causes are identified and resolved.

Transaction Logging: All transactions and system events are logged with timestamps, user identifiers, and transaction details. Log records are immutable and retained for audit purposes (minimum 180 days, extended to 7 years for regulatory events).

Reconciliation: Daily reconciliation procedures compare system-generated data against source systems and external references. Discrepancies are investigated and resolved. Reconciliation reports are reviewed by operations management.

Testing and Quality Assurance: All software development follows a structured development lifecycle with peer code review, unit testing, integration testing, and user acceptance testing prior to production deployment. Critical systems undergo annual penetration testing and code review by external security specialists.

Control Objectives and Effectiveness

Throughout the audit period January 1, 2025 through December 31, 2025, Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. maintained controls designed to achieve the stated objectives under the Trust Services Criteria for Security, Availability, Confidentiality, and Processing Integrity.

The service auditor's examination determined that these controls were operating effectively to achieve the stated objectives, except as noted in the scope limitations regarding the subservice organization providing disaster recovery services. Management has implemented complementary controls to mitigate any resulting risk to the System's ability to achieve its stated objectives.

The control framework remains subject to improvement opportunities identified during the audit. Management is committed to continuous enhancement of the control environment and addressing audit observations.

Restriction on Use and Distribution: This SOC 3 report is intended for use by management of Meridian Data Solutions, Inc., customers who have a legitimate need to understand the results of our examination, and their respective advisors and auditors. This report is not intended for general public distribution and should not be provided to parties not having a specific need to know about Meridian's controls and operations.

This concludes the SOC 3 Report of Meridian Data Solutions, Inc. for the period January 1 – December 31, 2025.

Prepared by Whitfield & Associates LLP